Use ChatGPT to Get Mom's Medicaid Application Paperwork in One Place

Four prompts to sort the records you have, see what you haven't found yet, keep one log of what has been sent and asked for, and list the questions to bring to a professional.

Where you are

Mom needs care now, and a Medicaid application is on your list along with everything else. There is a folder of statements, a stack of mail, and no single place that shows what you have, what is missing, or what has already been sent.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names, account numbers, and case numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not know your state's Medicaid rules, determine eligibility, or give legal or financial advice. Bring those questions to your Medicaid planner or an elder law attorney.

What you'll have at the end

You can say which records you have, which you still need to find, what has been submitted or requested so far, and which questions belong to a professional.

A one-page paperwork snapshot: What We Have, What We Still Need to Find, What Has Been Sent or Requested, and Questions for a Professional.

Before you start

- Whatever statements, letters, and records you have gathered so far, even if it is only a pile.
- Any letter or notice from the Medicaid agency, if one has arrived.
- A rough list of your parent's accounts, income, property, and insurance, without account numbers. You don't need everything.

PROMPT 1

Sort what you already have

WHY THIS MATTERS

When the paperwork is in a pile, it is hard to tell a nearly complete file from one with big holes. Sorting comes before searching.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A plain list of the documents and records you have found so far, in your own words. Leave out account numbers and Social Security numbers.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm helping my mother with a long-term-care Medicaid application. Here is a list of the documents and records I have found so far, described in my own words, with no account

> numbers:
>
> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Using only what I've listed, sort it under these headings: IDENTITY AND RESIDENCY, INCOME, BANK ACCOUNTS, INVESTMENTS AND RETIREMENT, INSURANCE, REAL ESTATE, TRUSTS AND ANNUITIES, CARE AND FACILITY INFORMATION, and NOT SURE WHERE THIS GOES. For each item, note the dates it covers if I gave them, and write "dates not noted" if I didn't. Do not add documents I didn't mention, and do not tell me what Medicaid requires in my state.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Your own pile, sorted, with the empty headings in plain view.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Fill in the dates you left out, and set the "not sure" items aside to ask about.

PROMPT 2

See what you haven't found yet

WHY THIS MATTERS

Important records may be missing, and it is easier to look for them when you can name them. The AI can't tell you what your state requires, but it can show you where you haven't looked.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The sorted list from the first prompt.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my sorted list of the records I have for my mother's Medicaid application:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULT OF PROMPT 1]
>
> Based only on this list, which headings are empty or thin? For each one, write a question I can answer by going through mail, files, or online accounts, or by asking a family member, such as "Does Mom have a life insurance policy?" Do not tell me which documents are legally required or how far back the statements must go. I will ask a professional about that. Just help me see what I haven't looked for yet.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short list of places to look and people to ask.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Start with the two or three that are quickest to check.

PROMPT 3

Keep one log of what has been sent and asked for

WHY THIS MATTERS

Once an application is under way, letters, calls, and requests arrive while care decisions continue. One dated log keeps a request from getting lost in the mail pile.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on what has been submitted, any letters or calls from the Medicaid agency, and what they asked for. Leave out case numbers.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are my notes on what has happened so far with my mother's Medicaid application: what was submitted and when, any letters or calls from the Medicaid agency, and anything they asked for:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES, WITHOUT CASE OR ACCOUNT NUMBERS]
>
> Turn this into a simple log with four columns: DATE, WHAT HAPPENED, WHAT WAS SENT OR ASKED FOR, and REPLY DATE STATED IN THE LETTER. Where I didn't give a date, write "date not noted." Do not work out any deadline for me and do not explain what a notice means. Copy only what my notes say. If nothing has been submitted yet, say so and leave the log ready to fill in.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One timeline in one place, with the blanks showing.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Check each "date not noted" against the letter itself, and bring anything you don't understand to a professional.

PROMPT 4

Sort your questions by who can answer them

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some questions you can answer by finding a document. Others, like when to apply or how to explain a transaction, belong to a professional. Knowing which is which is the point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts, plus the questions on your mind.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've put together about the paperwork for my mother's Medicaid application:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> And here are the questions I still have:
>
> [PASTE YOUR QUESTIONS]
>
> Give me one page with four headings: WHAT WE HAVE, WHAT WE STILL NEED TO FIND, WHAT HAS BEEN SENT OR REQUESTED, and QUESTIONS FOR A PROFESSIONAL. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, the Medicaid agency, or not sure. Do not answer questions about eligibility, timing, transfers, or what to put on the application. List them so I can ask.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to a professional so they can see where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've sorted the paperwork you have and the questions you can't answer alone. The planning interview is the next step: it produces a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›